

Word family: **decide / decides / decided / deciding / decision / decisive / decisively / indecisive / indecision**

Base word: decide

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

- * **decide** (v.) — 決定；作出選擇；判定
- * **decision** (n.) — 決定；裁決；判斷
- * **decisive** (adj.) — 果斷的；決定性的
- * **decisively** (adv.) — 果斷地；決定性地
- * **indecisive** (adj.) — 優柔寡斷的；不能作出決定的
- * **indecision** (n.) — 猶豫不決
- * **decided** (adj., less common) — 明確的；顯著的

Useful expressions / extensions:

- * **decide to do something**
- * **decide that... **
- * **decide what / where / whether... **
- * **decide between A and B**
- * **decide on something**
- * **decide against something**
- * **decide for yourself**
- * **can't decide**
- * **be decided by**
- * **decide a case / dispute**
- * **decision-making**
- * **make a decision**
- * **reach / come to a decision**
- * **final decision**
- * **decisive factor**
- * **decisive moment**
- * **decisive victory**
- * **indecisive person**

Meaning in this passage

> I **decided to give** her that album because I wanted to give her something with emotional weight rather than something merely practical.

Here, **decided** means:

made a deliberate choice after thinking about what to do — 決定；作出選擇

The speaker considered different possible gifts and chose to give his mother the handmade album.

中文翻譯：

我**決定送**她那本相簿，因為我想送她一份有情感重量的禮物，而不只是單純實用的東西。

So here:

decide to do something = 考慮後決定採取某個行動

1. **decide to do something — 決定做某事**

This is the exact pattern used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I **decided to give** her that album.

我**決定送**她那本相簿。

Practice 2

> She **decided to study** abroad.

她**決定到外國讀書**。

Practice 3

> We **decided to leave** early.

我們**決定提早離開**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decide to do X = 經過考慮後選擇去做 X

2. **decide that... — 決定 / 認定.....**

Practice 1

> We **decided that** the cheaper option was better.

我們**決定**較便宜的選擇比較好。

Practice 2

> She **decided that** she needed more time.

她**認為並決定**自己需要更多時間。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decide that + clause = 經過考慮後得出並採納某個決定或結論****

3. ****decide what / where / when / how... — 決定甚麼 / 哪裏 / 何時 / 如何.....****

Practice 1

> I haven't **decided what to buy** yet.

我還未**決定買甚麼**。

Practice 2

> We need to **decide where to meet**.

我們需要**決定在哪裏見面**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decide + question word + to-infinitive = 對某個具體選項作出選擇****

4. ****decide whether / if... — 決定是否.....****

Practice 1

> She hasn't **decided whether to accept the offer**.

她還未**決定是否接受這個提議**。

Practice 2

> We need to **decide if we should go**.

我們需要**決定是否應該去**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decide whether/if = 在做或不做某事之間作出選擇****

5. ****decide between A and B — 在 A 和 B 之間選擇****

Practice 1

> I can't ****decide between the blue one and the black one****.

我無法****在藍色和黑色之間作出選擇****。

Practice 2

> She had to ****decide between two job offers****.

她必須****在兩份工作邀請之間作決定****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decide between A and B = 從兩個或以上選項中選擇其中一個****

6. ****decide on something — 選定；決定採用****

A very useful pattern.

Practice 1

> We finally ****decided on a restaurant****.

我們最後****選定了一間餐廳****。

Practice 2

> Have you ****decided on a date**** for the meeting?

你們已經****選定會議日期****了嗎？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decide on X = 在多個可能選項中最後選定 X****

7. **decide against something / doing something — 決定不做 / 不用**

Practice 1

> We **decided against buying** the expensive one.

我們**決定不買**那個昂貴的。

Practice 2

> She **decided against the plan**.

她**決定不採用那個計劃**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decide against X = 考慮後選擇不接受、不採用或不進行 X

8. **decide for yourself — 自己決定**

Practice 1

> You should **decide for yourself**.

你應該**自己決定**。

Practice 2

> I gave him the facts and let him **decide for himself**.

我把事實告訴他，讓他**自己作決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decide for yourself = 不依賴別人替你選擇，而由自己作出決定

9. **can't decide / be unable to decide — 拿不定主意**

Practice 1

> I **can't decide** what to wear.

我**拿不定主意**穿甚麼。

Practice 2

> He stood there, **unable to decide**.

他站在那裏，**猶豫不決**。

MCQ-ready definition:

can't decide = 在多個選項之間無法作出選擇

10. **decide** (使結果確定；決定結果) — 決定；左右結果

A major separate sense.

Practice 1

> One goal **decided the match**.

一個入球**決定了比賽結果**。

Practice 2

> The final vote could **decide the outcome**.

最後一次投票可能會**決定結果**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decide something = 成為令某件事最終有結果的關鍵因素

11. **be decided by something** — 由.....決定

Practice 1

> The winner will be **decided by the judges**.

勝出者將由評判**決定**。

Practice 2

> The final result was **decided by one point**.

最終結果由一分之差**決定**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be decided by X = 最終結果由 X 作出判定或受到 X 關鍵性影響****

12. ****decide a case / dispute — 裁決案件 / 爭議****

A formal/legal or institutional sense.

Practice 1

> The court will ****decide the case**** next month.

法院將於下月****裁決案件****。

Practice 2

> An independent panel was asked to ****decide the dispute****.

一個獨立委員會被要求****裁定這宗爭議****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decide a case/dispute = 由有權力的人或機構正式判定結果****

13. ****decision (決定 ; 選擇) — 決定****

Practice 1

> It was a difficult ****decision****.

那是一個很難作出的****決定****。

Practice 2

> She made the ****decision**** to leave.

她作出了離開的****決定****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decision = 經過考慮後作出的選擇或結論****

14. ****make a decision — 作出決定****

Practice 1

> I need more time to **make a decision**.

我需要更多時間來**作出決定**。

Practice 2

> Don't **make a decision** when you're angry.

生氣時不要**作決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make a decision = 經過考慮後正式選定一個做法或答案

15. **reach / come to a decision** — 作出 / 達成決定

Practice 1

> We finally **reached a decision**.

我們終於**作出了決定**。

Practice 2

> The committee has not yet **come to a decision**.

委員會仍未**作出決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reach/come to a decision = 經過討論或思考後最終得出決定

16. **final decision** — 最終決定

Practice 1

> The **final decision** is yours.

最終決定由你作出。

Practice 2

> No **final decision** has been made yet.

目前仍未作出**最終決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

final decision = 不再預期進一步更改的最後決定

17. **decision-making** — 決策；作決定的過程

Practice 1

> Good **decision-making** requires reliable information.

良好的**決策**需要可靠資料。

Practice 2

> Staff should be involved in **decision-making**.

員工應參與**決策過程**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decision-making = 分析選項並作出決定的過程

18. **decision-maker** — 決策者

Practice 1

> Managers are often key **decision-makers**.

經理通常是重要的**決策者**。

Practice 2

> The report is aimed at senior **decision-makers**.

這份報告是寫給高層**決策者**看的。

MCQ-ready definition:

decision-maker = 有權或負責作出重要決定的人

19. **decisive** (果斷的) — 果斷的；能迅速作決定的

Practice 1

> A good leader sometimes needs to be **decisive**.

好的領導者有時需要很**果斷**。

Practice 2

> She was calm and **decisive** under pressure.

她在壓力下仍然冷靜而**果斷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decisive = 能清楚而迅速作出決定，不會長時間猶豫

20. **decisive** (決定性的；關鍵的) — 決定性的

A different adjective sense.

Practice 1

> Her experience was the **decisive factor**.

她的經驗是**決定性因素**。

Practice 2

> The final goal proved **decisive**.

最後一個入球證明是**決定勝負的關鍵**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decisive = 對最終結果有關鍵作用、足以決定結果的

21. **decisive factor** — 決定性因素

Practice 1

> Cost was the **decisive factor** in our choice.

成本是我們選擇時的**決定性因素**。

Practice 2

> Location became the **decisive factor**.

地點成為了**關鍵決定因素**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decisive factor = 最終令某個結果或選擇確定下來的關鍵因素

22. **decisive moment — 關鍵時刻**

Practice 1

> That was the **decisive moment** in the match.

那是比賽中的**關鍵時刻**。

Practice 2

> Her answer came at a **decisive moment**.

她的回答出現在一個**決定性的時刻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decisive moment = 對後續結果產生關鍵影響的時刻

23. **decisive victory — 壓倒性 / 明確勝利**

Practice 1

> The team achieved a **decisive victory**.

球隊取得了一場**明確而具決定性的勝利**。

Practice 2

> They won a **decisive victory** in the final.

他們在決賽中取得**大勝**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decisive victory = 結果非常清楚、沒有太大疑問的勝利****

24. ****decisively — 果斷地；決定性地****

Practice 1

> She acted ****decisively****.

她****果斷地****採取行動。

Practice 2

> The team won ****decisively****.

球隊以****明顯優勢****獲勝。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****decisively = 以果斷方式，或以足以明確決定結果的方式****

25. ****indecisive (優柔寡斷的) — 猶豫不決的****

Practice 1

> He can be very ****indecisive****.

他有時非常****優柔寡斷****。

Practice 2

> She felt ****indecisive**** about which course to choose.

她對選哪個課程感到****拿不定主意****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****indecisive = 難以作出清楚決定，常在選項之間反覆猶豫****

26. ****indecision — 猶豫不決****

Practice 1

> His **indecision** delayed the project.

他的**猶豫不決**拖延了項目。

Practice 2

> After a moment of **indecision**, she chose the blue one.

她**猶豫**了一會兒後選了藍色的。

MCQ-ready definition:

indecision = 無法迅速或清楚作出決定的狀態

27. **decided** (明確的 ; 顯著的) — 明顯的 ; 明確的

This adjective is less common than **decisive**, but still useful.

Practice 1

> There has been a **decided improvement** in his work.

他的工作表現有了**明顯改善**。

Practice 2

> She spoke with a **decided preference** for the first option.

她表達了對第一個選項**非常明確的偏好**。

MCQ-ready definition:

decided = clearly noticeable or definite

中文 :

明顯而確定的 ; 毫不含糊的

Important distinction 1: **decide** vs **choose**

choose

focuses on selecting one option.

decide

focuses on reaching a conclusion after consideration.

> choose the red shirt

選紅色恤衫

> decide to buy the red shirt

決定買紅色恤衫

Often they overlap, but the grammar differs.

Important distinction 2: **decide vs make up your mind**

Very close.

decide

neutral and standard.

make up your mind

more conversational and often emphasizes ending hesitation.

> I decided to go.

我決定去。

> I finally made up my mind to go.

我終於下定決心去。

Important distinction 3: **decide vs determine**

decide

usually involves choice or judgment.

determine

can mean:

- * establish a fact
- * control an outcome
- * formally decide

> decide what to do

決定做甚麼

> determine the cause

確定原因

Important distinction 4: **decide to do vs decide on**

decide to do

chooses an action.

> decide to travel

決定旅行

decide on

selects a thing/option.

> decide on a hotel

選定酒店

This grammar distinction is especially useful.

Important distinction 5: **decide against vs refuse**

decide against

consider an option and then reject it.

refuse

actively say no to a request, offer, or action.

> We decided against moving.

我們考慮後決定不搬。

> He refused to move.

他拒絕搬。

Important distinction 6: **decide for yourself vs decide by yourself**

decide for yourself

make your own judgment.

decide by yourself

can mean decide without help, but is less idiomatic for the idea of personal autonomy.

So:

> You must decide for yourself.

= 你必須自己拿主意。

Important distinction 7: **decide vs agree**

A group may **agree** on a decision, but these are not identical.

decide

reach the choice.

agree

share the same view.

> We decided to leave.

我們決定離開。

> We agreed to leave.

我們一致同意離開。

Important distinction 8: **decision vs choice**

choice

can mean:

- * the act of choosing
- * the options available

decision

the conclusion reached.

> I had no choice.

我別無選擇。

> I made a difficult decision.

我作了一個艱難決定。

Important distinction 9: **decision vs judgement**

decision

what is chosen.

judgement

the ability/process of evaluating what is sensible or correct.

A good judgement may lead to a good decision.

Important distinction 10: **decisive = 果斷的 vs decisive = 決定性的**

Two important adjective senses.

Person/action

> a decisive leader

果斷的領導者

Factor/event

> a decisive factor

決定性的因素

Do not translate both mechanically as 「果斷的」.

Important distinction 11: **decisive vs decided**

decisive

* able to make decisions

* determines an outcome

decided

* definite, noticeable, clear

> a decisive leader

果斷的領導者

> a decided improvement

明顯的改善

Important distinction 12: **indecisive vs uncertain**

indecisive

unable to make a choice.

uncertain

not sure about facts, future, or what is correct.

You can be uncertain without needing to make a decision.

Important distinction 13: **decide a case vs decide to do something**

Personal choice

> decide to leave

決定離開

Formal judgment

> the court decided the case

法院裁決案件

The second sense means **判定 / 裁決**, not personal preference.

Important distinction 14: **decide the result vs predict the result**

decide

causes or determines what the result actually is.

predict

says what you think the result will be beforehand.

> One goal decided the match.

一球決定了賽果。

> He predicted the match result.

他預測了賽果。

Important distinction 15: **decision-making vs making a decision**

make a decision

one particular act.

decision-making

the general process/skill/system of making decisions.

> I made a decision yesterday.

我昨天作了一個決定。

> Good decision-making takes practice.

良好的決策能力需要練習。

Family-extension note

Decide has two major semantic branches:

1. **make a choice / reach a conclusion**

- * decide to do
- * decide that
- * decide between
- * decide on
- * decide against
- * decide for yourself

2. **determine or formally settle an outcome**

- * decide a match
- * decide the result
- * decide a case
- * be decided by

The noun family then expands into:

3. **decision**

- * make a decision

- * final decision
- * decision-making

And the adjective family divides nicely into:

4. **decisive = 果斷的**

- * decisive person
- * decisive action

5. **decisive = 決定性的**

- * decisive factor
- * decisive moment

with the opposite:

6. **indecisive / indecision**

- * 優柔寡斷
- * 猶豫不決

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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decide to do	決定做.....	choose action
decide that	決定 / 認定.....	reach conclusion
decide what/where/how	決定甚麼 / 哪裏 / 如何	select details
decide whether	決定是否	yes/no choice
decide between A and B	在 A、B 之間選擇	compare options
decide on X	選定 X	settle on option
decide against X	決定不用 / 不做 X	reject option
decide for yourself	自己決定	independent judgment
can't decide	拿不定主意	unable to choose
decide an outcome	決定結果	determine result
decide a case	裁決案件	formal judgment
decision	決定	chosen conclusion
make a decision	作出決定	decide
reach a decision	達成決定	arrive at conclusion
final decision	最終決定	last decision
decision-making	決策	decision process
decision-maker	決策者	person with authority
decisive (person)	果斷的	makes decisions firmly

decisive (factor)	決定性的	determines outcome	
decisive factor	決定性因素	key cause	
decisive moment	關鍵時刻	result-changing moment	
decisively	果斷地 / 決定性地	firm or conclusive	
indecisive	優柔寡斷的	unable to choose	
indecision	猶豫不決	lack of decision	
decided	明確的；顯著的	definite/noticeable	

For your original sentence

> I ****decided to give**** her that album because I wanted to give her something with emotional weight rather than something merely practical.

Here:

****decide to give = 經過考慮後，選擇把那本相簿送給她****

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我****決定送她那本相簿****，因為我想送她一份有情感重量的禮物，而不只是單純實用的東西。

The exact pattern is:

****decide + to-infinitive****

> decide ****to give****

> decide ****to leave****

> decide ****to wait****

And the key meaning here is straightforward ****「作出選擇 / 決定採取某個行動」****, not the separate ****「決定結果 / 裁決」**** sense.